they could identify. I listened to the recording later, at the hearing, and you could hear Graeme's voice loud and clear. He still laughs about how he got away without being charged to this day. I guess I had to take one for the team.

After the game, match referee Chris Broad called a disciplinary hearing, where I had to appear with Goolam Rajah, our team manager. The Pakistan manager and their captain, Inzamamul-Haq, were also in attendance. 'I've had a complaint,' said Chris, opening the proceedings, 'from the Pakistan manager that you've broken one of the clauses in the ICC rules, relating to racist remarks.'

Fortunately, the Proteas management were behind me on this one. You could call me many, many things, but a racist was a bit of a stretch, to say the least. Especially concerning Muslims. I'm coloured, for goodness' sake. I've got four Muslim aunts and about 10 Muslim cousins. How could I be a racist? My damn family is Muslim. Goolam Rajah had echoed my surprise when he first heard what the charge was. 'You've got Muslim family; how can they call *you* a racist?' he asked, aghast. He's good at looking aghast.

Anyway, that was the charge. I couldn't deny that that was my voice on the tape, so I admitted that I'd said those words. I was found guilty, but I did make a point of apologising to the Pakistan captain, Inzy, asking him to convey my apology to the rest of his team. I told him that I had a Muslim family, so they shouldn't believe I was racist. 'Okay, cool,' said Inzy. That's all. He doesn't talk much, does Inzy.

Their manager looked really pissed off, though. He wanted me banned for longer than the sentence eventually handed down. The judgment was a two-match Test ban, which we appealed. The ICC's code of conduct commissioner, Richie Benaud, then changed the ban to one Test, one 20/20 game and one ODI match – all against Pakistan. To be honest, I think it was a tactic aimed at getting me out of the team rather than them being mortally offended by the 'racial' slur. It was a gambit to disrupt the Proteas more than anything else.

Mavericks

A few months after my divorce from Tenielle, and after I had returned to South Africa from playing county cricket in the UK, I attended the launch of a Hugo Boss store at the V&A Waterfront in Cape Town. I knew the Hugo Boss guys pretty well, and a few mates of mine from another